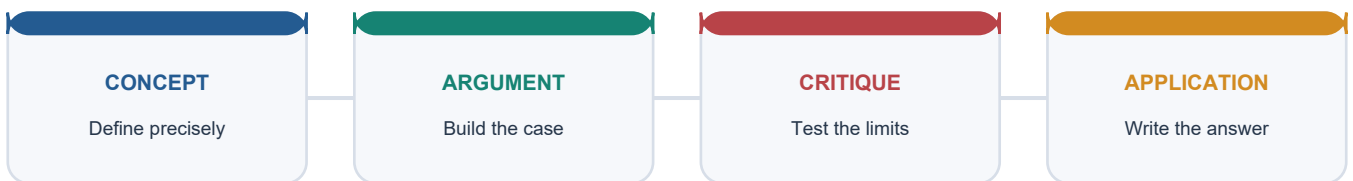


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Marxism and Neo-Marxism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Marxism and Neo-Marxism - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 04 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Classical Marxism**?

- A. the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- B. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- C. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.
- D. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Classical Marxism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Dialectical materialism, not Classical Marxism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Base vs superstructure, not Classical Marxism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Forces of production vs relations of production, not Classical Marxism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Classical Marxism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Dialectical materialism**?

- A. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.
- B. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- C. the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- D. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Base vs superstructure, not Dialectical materialism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Dialectical materialism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Classical Marxism, not Dialectical materialism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Forces of production vs relations of production, not Dialectical materialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Dialectical materialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Historical materialism**?

- A. classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.
- B. argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires.
- C. the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.
- D. economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism, not Historical materialism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Herbert Marcuse, not Historical materialism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Historical materialism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Historical materialism restated as a mechanism, not Historical materialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Historical materialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Surplus value**?

- A. represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.
- B. the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.
- C. Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism.
- D. the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Louis Althusser, not Surplus value.

- **B:** B Attaches to Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism, not Surplus value.
- **C:** C Attaches to Core focus, not Surplus value.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Surplus value.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Surplus value by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism**?

- A. the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.
- B. Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.
- C. Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.
- D. Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (Section 15, Chains 1-2).

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Young Marx, not Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Frankfurt School, not Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism.
- **D:** D Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Base vs superstructure**?

- A. founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.
- B. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.
- C. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.
- D. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Marx and Engels, not Base vs superstructure.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Base vs superstructure.
- **C:** C Attaches to Forces of production vs relations of production, not Base vs superstructure.
- **D:** D Attaches to Dialectical materialism, not Base vs superstructure.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Base vs superstructure by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Forces of production vs relations of production**?

- A. base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.
- B. founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.
- C. forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.
- D. the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Base vs superstructure, not Forces of production vs relations of production.
- **B:** B Attaches to Marx and Engels, not Forces of production vs relations of production.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Forces of production vs relations of production.
- **D:** D Attaches to Dialectical materialism, not Forces of production vs relations of production.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Forces of production vs relations of production by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism**?

- A. argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires.
- B. economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48).
- C. the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.
- D. classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Herbert Marcuse, not Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Historical materialism restated as a mechanism, not Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Historical materialism, not Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Base determines superstructure mechanically - Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.
- B. Marx and Engels - the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- C. Forces of production vs relations of production - Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.
- D. Base vs superstructure - Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Matches the record: Base determines superstructure mechanically is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Marx and Engels is recorded with founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Forces of production vs relations of production is recorded with forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Base vs superstructure is recorded with base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Base determines superstructure mechanically; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Base vs superstructure - the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- B. Marx and Engels - founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.
- C. Forces of production vs relations of production - the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive.
- D. Base determines superstructure mechanically - Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Base vs superstructure is recorded with base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.
- **B:** B Matches the record: Marx and Engels is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Forces of production vs relations of production is recorded with forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Base determines superstructure mechanically is recorded with Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Marx and Engels; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Mark-weight cue (10/15) - the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.
- B. Human problem - Marx, Engels, Lenin, Luxemburg, Mao; this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.
- C. Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong - Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism.
- D. Core focus - represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Human problem is recorded with Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Core focus is recorded with Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse" - founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of...
- B. Frankfurt School - Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.
- C. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism - represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of.
- D. Young Marx - Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Frankfurt School is recorded with Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism is recorded with the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.
- **D:** D Exact pair: Young Marx is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Young Marx; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Frankfurt School - Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique.
- B. Young Marx - Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.
- C. "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse" - founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of...
- D. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism - represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source-exact: Frankfurt School is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Young Marx is recorded with Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.

- **C:** C Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism is recorded with the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Frankfurt School; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Historical materialism - the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- B. Herbert Marcuse - argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires.
- C. Historical materialism restated as a mechanism - the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- D. Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism - base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Historical materialism is recorded with the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.
- **B:** B Correct attachment: Herbert Marcuse is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Historical materialism restated as a mechanism is recorded with economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48).
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism is recorded with classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Herbert Marcuse; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Young Marx - Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.
- B. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism - Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and.
- C. Louis Althusser - represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and modes of production.
- D. Surplus value - Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (Section 15, Chains 1-2).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Young Marx is recorded with Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects.

- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism is recorded with the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Louis Althusser is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Surplus value is recorded with the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Louis Althusser; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Surplus value - the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to.
- B. Mark-weight cue (10/15) - Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.
- C. Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong - represents the scientific strain of neo-Marxism focused on structures and.
- D. Core focus - Property, class division and revolutionary transformation of capitalism.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: Surplus value is recorded with the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong is recorded with Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism.
- **D:** D Source-exact: Core focus is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Core focus; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Human problem** is associated with: Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.
2. **Mode of production** is associated with: Scale the number of thinkers and depth of objection-reply chain (Section 20).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Human problem does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Key names** is associated with: when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gaubá, PDF p.49).
2. **Fetter/rupture mechanism** is associated with: when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gaubá, PDF p.49).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Key names does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Historical materialism restated as a mechanism** is associated with: economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaubá, PDF p.48).
2. **Base-superstructure - non-mechanical** is associated with: the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gaubá's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gaubá, PDF pp.48, 53).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.

- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Historical materialism restated as a mechanism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Mode of production** is associated with: Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (Section 15, Chains 1-2).
2. **"Critically examine"/"Critically analyse"** is associated with: the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Mode of production does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Fetter/rupture mechanism** is associated with: when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning -> feudal -> capitalist -> socialist/communist (Gaub, PDF p.49).
2. **Mark-weight cue (10/15)** is associated with: the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Fetter/rupture mechanism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Base-superstructure - non-mechanical** is associated with: the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
2. **Classical Marxism** is associated with: the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Base-superstructure - non-mechanical does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **"Critically examine"/"Critically analyse"** is associated with: Test the "economism" charge against Gramsci/Althusser's superstructural correctives (Section 15, Chains 1-2).
2. **Dialectical materialism** is associated with: the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with "Critically examine"/"Critically analyse" does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Mark-weight cue (10/15)** is associated with: the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.
2. **Historical materialism** is associated with: forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Mark-weight cue (10/15) does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Historical materialism means economics alone explains everything.**?

- A. Gauba's neo-Marxist section explicitly notes growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure. (PDF p.53)
- B. Gauba presents it as a development within Marxism, especially around alienation, ideology and emancipation. (PDF pp.47, 53-54)
- C. Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53)
- D. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's neo-Marxist section explicitly notes growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure. (PDF p.53).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Neo-Marxism abandons Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is automatically identical with market price movement.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Historical materialism means economics alone, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Neo-Marxism abandons Marxism.**?

- A. Gauba's neo-Marxist section explicitly notes growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure. (PDF p.53)
- B. Gauba presents it as a development within Marxism, especially around alienation, ideology and emancipation. (PDF pp.47, 53-54)
- C. Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53)
- D. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Historical materialism means economics alone explains everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba presents it as a development within Marxism, especially around alienation, ideology and emancipation. (PDF pp.47, 53-54).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is automatically identical with market price movement.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Neo-Marxism abandons Marxism, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is automatically identical with market price movement.**?

- A. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- B. Gauba's neo-Marxist section explicitly notes growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure. (PDF p.53)
- C. Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53)
- D. Gauba presents it as a development within Marxism, especially around alienation, ideology and emancipation. (PDF pp.47, 53-54)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Historical materialism means economics alone explains everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Neo-Marxism abandons Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.?**

- A. Dialectical materialism means the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- B. Gauba's neo-Marxist section explicitly notes growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure. (PDF p.53)
- C. Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53)
- D. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Dialectical materialism means forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Historical materialism means economics alone explains everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is automatically identical with market price movement.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Dialectical materialism means forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.?**

- A. Dialectical materialism means the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- B. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- C. Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53)
- D. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Dialectical materialism means the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is automatically identical with market price movement.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Dialectical materialism means forces include means, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Historical materialism means classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.**?

- A. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.
- B. Historical materialism means the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and.
- C. Dialectical materialism means the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- D. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Historical materialism means the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Dialectical materialism means forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Historical materialism means classical Marxism, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Surplus value means Gauba explicitly notes that later Marxist debate recognizes interdependence between base and superstructure.**?

- A. Gauba's neo-Marxist section explicitly notes growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure. (PDF p.53)
- B. Gauba presents it as a development within Marxism, especially around alienation, ideology and emancipation. (PDF pp.47, 53-54)
- C. Surplus value means the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.
- D. Gauba defines it as the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist, not simply any change in sale price. (PDF pp.52-53)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Historical materialism means economics alone explains everything.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Neo-Marxism abandons Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Surplus value means the unpaid part of labour appropriated by the capitalist as profit, rent and interest.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Surplus value means any profit whatsoever is automatically identical with market price movement.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Surplus value means Gauba explicitly notes that, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production.?**

- A. Classical Marxism means the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.
- B. Historical materialism means the claim that economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and.
- C. Dialectical materialism means the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.
- D. Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Classical Marxism means base refers to the mode of production; superstructure includes law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Historical materialism means classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Dialectical materialism means forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism means the first is the philosophical basis; the second is the scientific-historical application to society.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Dialectical materialism vs historical materialism, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Marxism and Neo-Marxism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain the relation between forces and relations of production in historical materialism. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive explain requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of the relation between forces and relations of production in historical materialism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Historical, Core and Forces, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Historical change occurs when developing productive forces are constrained by existing relations of ownership and control, but the transition is mediated through social and political struggle rather than mechanical necessity.

Model answer (149 words):

Introduction: Historical materialism explains social formations through the interaction of productive capacity and the social relations governing production. Core analysis: Forces of production include labour, skills, tools and technology. Relations of production organise ownership, control and the position of classes. Together they constitute a mode of production. As productive forces develop, inherited relations may become fetters that obstruct further development. The resulting contradiction is expressed through class struggle and may culminate in institutional rupture and a new social formation. The mechanism links material production to law, politics and ideology without reducing history to isolated ideas. Critical evaluation: The relation is not an automatic sequence. Political organisation, culture and contingent struggle influence whether contradiction produces reform, repression or revolution. Conclusion: Historical change occurs when developing productive forces are constrained by existing relations of ownership and control, but the transition is mediated through social and political struggle rather than mechanical necessity.

Why this earns marks: it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Historical, Core and Forces), converts that evidence into analysis of the relation between forces and relations of production in historical materialism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Historical change occurs when developing productive forces are constrained by existing relations of ownership and control, but the transition is mediated through social and political struggle rather than mechanical necessity. At 149 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Present Marx's concept of alienation and distinguish it from economic inequality. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of marx's concept of alienation and distinguish it from economic inequality in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Alienation, Core and Inequality, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that critical evaluation: The concept depends on a contested account of human flourishing, but it remains powerful when reconstructed around agency, recognition and meaningful control over work.

Model answer (141 words):

Introduction: Alienation describes the worker's estrangement within capitalist production and is broader than unequal income or wealth. Core analysis: The worker is alienated from the product, which confronts its producer as another's property; from the labour process, which is externally controlled; from species-being, because creative activity is reduced to a means of survival; and from other persons, whose relations are mediated by competition and exchange. Inequality concerns distribution, whereas alienation concerns control, purpose and self-realisation within the

productive relation. A redistribution of income can therefore reduce inequality while leaving alienated labour intact. Critical evaluation: The concept depends on a contested account of human flourishing, but it remains powerful when reconstructed around agency, recognition and meaningful control over work. Conclusion: Alienation concerns loss of control, self-realisation and human relation within production; redistribution may reduce inequality without removing that deeper form of estrangement.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Alienation, Core and Inequality), converts that evidence into analysis of marx's concept of alienation and distinguish it from economic inequality, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that critical evaluation: The concept depends on a contested account of human flourishing, but it remains powerful when reconstructed around agency, recognition and meaningful control over work. At 141 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Critically examine the base-superstructure relation in classical and neo-Marxist thought. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *critically examine* requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine the base-superstructure relation in classical and neo-Marxist thought in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Classical Marxism and Neo-Marxists, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that yet the relation should not be read as a one-way switch.

Model answer (139 words):

Introduction: The base-superstructure model relates the mode of production to legal, political and cultural institutions. Core analysis: Classical Marxism gives the economic structure decisive explanatory weight because ownership and production organise class power. Yet the relation should not be read as a one-way switch. Neo-Marxists develop its reciprocal character: Gramsci shows how civil society and hegemony organise consent; the Frankfurt School examines culture and manipulated needs; Althusser analyses ideological and repressive apparatuses that reproduce social relations. The superstructure therefore stabilises or contests the base rather than merely reflecting it. Further development: Gramsci and Althusser illustrate two different corrections. If culture becomes completely autonomous, the distinctively Marxist account of material power is lost. Conclusion: The relation is best read as structured interaction: the economic base sets powerful limits, while law, politics and culture also reproduce or transform the social order.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *critically examine* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Classical Marxism and Neo-Marxists), converts that evidence into analysis of examine the base-superstructure relation in classical and neo-Marxist thought, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that yet the relation should not be read as a one-way switch. At 139 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Discuss Gramsci's concept of hegemony as a development within Marxism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *discuss* requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of gramsci's concept of hegemony as a development within Marxism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Gramsci, Marxism and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that the risk is stretching hegemony so widely that every form of agreement appears manipulated.

Model answer (232 words):

Introduction: Gramsci develops Marxism by explaining why class rule persists through consent as well as direct coercion. Core analysis: Hegemony is the capacity of a leading class to present its interests as a common social outlook through institutions of civil society, including education, religion, media and associations. Political society supplies law and coercion, while civil society secures active or passive consent. Organic intellectuals organise rival experience into a counter-hegemonic worldview. In advanced societies, transformation therefore requires a prolonged

war of position within civil society rather than reliance only on a frontal seizure of state power. Further development: The distinction between war of manoeuvre and war of position follows from this analysis. A direct assault may be possible where civil society is weak, but dense associations in advanced societies require a long struggle over common sense and institutional leadership. This expands revolutionary strategy beyond the factory and the state. It also allows subordinate groups to build consent before taking governmental power, though it raises the question of whether counter-hegemony can avoid becoming another form of ideological closure. Critical evaluation: Gramsci gives culture and agency greater causal weight without abandoning class analysis. The risk is stretching hegemony so widely that every form of agreement appears manipulated. Conclusion: Gramsci extends Marxism by showing that durable rule depends on organised consent in civil society as well as coercion, thereby making culture a terrain of political struggle.

Why this earns marks: it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Gramsci, Marxism and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of Gramsci's concept of hegemony as a development within Marxism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that the risk is stretching hegemony so widely that every form of agreement appears manipulated. At 232 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Marxism as a theory of capitalism, domination and social transformation. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of Marxism as a theory of capitalism, domination and social transformation in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Marxism, Core and Historical, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Marxism remains powerful where exploitation, accumulation and class power intersect, but its adequacy depends on resisting economic reductionism and authoritarian political closure.

Model answer (246 words):

Introduction: Marxism combines a method of social analysis, a critique of capitalism, a theory of historical change and a political project. Core analysis: Its analysis links private control of production to surplus appropriation, class conflict and the structural dependence of labour. Historical materialism explains how productive forces and relations generate contradictions, while alienation identifies the human cost of externally controlled work. The state and dominant ideas help stabilise class relations. Neo-Marxism deepens the account through hegemony, culture, ideology and dependency, showing that domination is not maintained by economics alone. Further development: Its evidence architecture spans several levels: surplus value explains appropriation within production; alienation explains loss of agency; the state protects general conditions of class rule; ideology naturalises contingent relations; and historical materialism links contradiction to transformation. Gramsci and the Frankfurt School explain why crisis need not automatically produce revolution, while dependency theory extends domination to colonial and neo-colonial relations. The strongest reply to Marxism is that democratic welfare reform, plural identities and state autonomy exceed a simple two-class model. Its strongest defence is that these modifications do not remove the structural power attached to ownership and accumulation. That residual insight sustains its contemporary relevance. Critical evaluation: Marxism remains illuminating where accumulation and class power interact, but deterministic prediction, class reductionism and authoritarian outcomes weaken any claim to a complete philosophy of emancipation. Conclusion: Marxism remains powerful where exploitation, accumulation and class power intersect, but its adequacy depends on resisting economic reductionism and authoritarian political closure.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Marxism, Core and Historical), converts that evidence into analysis of Marxism as a theory of capitalism, domination and social transformation, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Marxism remains powerful where exploitation, accumulation and class power intersect, but its adequacy depends on resisting economic reductionism and authoritarian political closure. At 246 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Compare the humanist, structural and dependency-oriented strands of neo-Marxism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of the humanist, structural and dependency-oriented strands of neo-Marxism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Neo-Marxism, Marxism and Core, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: These strands disagree over agency, structure and the scale of domination, yet each preserves Marxism by relocating causal weight beyond a mechanically conceived economic base.

Model answer (241 words):

Introduction: Neo-Marxism revises classical Marxism by widening the mechanisms and scales through which domination is explained. Core analysis: The humanist strand, associated with the Young Marx and critical theory, emphasises alienation, freedom, culture and manipulated consciousness. The structural strand, represented by Althusser, resists a philosophy centred on an essential human subject and analyses how economic, political and ideological structures reproduce a social formation. Dependency theorists shift the scale toward relations between developing societies and colonial or neo-colonial power. These strands therefore differ over agency, causal structure and the principal arena of conflict. Further development: The strands also prescribe different emancipatory strategies. Humanism seeks recovery of agency and non-alienated life; structural analysis seeks transformation of the apparatuses reproducing class relations; dependency analysis seeks altered domestic and international relations of production. Gramsci occupies an important bridge because he combines material class leadership with cultural struggle. Habermas should not be merged with first-generation critical theory, and dependency theory should not be renamed world-systems theory without independent justification. Their plurality strengthens Marxism's reach but weakens any claim to one settled neo-Marxist method. Comparison must therefore retain both continuity and internal disagreement. Critical evaluation: They should not be merged with world-systems theory or treated as abandoning Marxism. Each retains concern with material domination while correcting an overly mechanical base model. Conclusion: These strands disagree over agency, structure and the scale of domination, yet each preserves Marxism by relocating causal weight beyond a mechanically conceived economic base.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Neo-Marxism, Marxism and Core), converts that evidence into analysis of the humanist, structural and dependency-oriented strands of neo-Marxism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: These strands disagree over agency, structure and the scale of domination, yet each preserves Marxism by relocating causal weight beyond a mechanically conceived economic base. At 241 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.